

Aquifer Open Study Notes (Profiles)

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Women Named Mary

The Gospels mention four other Marys besides the mother of Jesus:

1. *Mary Magdalene*, likely from Magdala in Galilee, was freed from demon possession by Jesus ([Mark 16:9](#)). She became a loyal follower and supported Jesus and his disciples financially ([Luke 8:1–3](#); see also [Matthew 27:55–56](#); [Mark 15:40–41](#)). She witnessed Jesus's death on the cross and his burial ([Matthew 27:55–61](#); [Mark 15:40–47](#); [John 19:25](#); compare [Luke 23:49, 55–56](#)). She went to the tomb early on Sunday morning with burial spices. She was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead ([Matthew 28:1–8](#); [Mark 16:1–8](#); [Luke 24:1–11, 22–24](#)). She was also the first to see the risen Jesus ([Matthew 28:9–10](#); [Mark 16:9–11](#); [John 20:1–2, 11–18](#)).
2. *Mary, the mother of James the younger* (not the apostle) and Joseph, was among the women present at Jesus's death on the cross and his burial ([Matthew 27:55–61](#); [Mark 15:40–47](#); see also [Luke 23:49, 55](#)). Like Mary Magdalene, she was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead ([Matthew 28:1–8](#); [Mark 16:1–8](#); [Luke 24:1–11](#)). She was also one of the first to see the risen Jesus ([Matthew 28:9–10](#)).
3. *Mary of Bethany* was Martha and Lazarus's sister. Jesus loved their family very much ([John 11:5](#)). Jesus praised Mary for wanting to learn from him ([Luke 10:38–42](#)). Soon after Jesus raised her brother from the dead ([John 11:32–45](#)), Mary anointed Jesus's feet with very expensive perfume. Jesus defended her when others said it was wasteful ([John 12:1–11](#); compare [Matthew 26:6–13](#); [Mark 14:3–9](#)).
4. *Mary, the wife of Clopas*, was among the women watching when Jesus died on the cross ([John 19:25](#)). The New Testament does not mention her husband, Clopas, elsewhere.

Passages for Further Study

[Matthew 27:55–61](#); [28:1](#); [Mark 15:40–47](#); [16:1–11](#); [Luke 8:2–3](#); [10:38–42](#); [24:1–10](#); [John 11:1–6](#), [17–24](#); [12:3–8](#); [19:25](#); [20:1–2, 11–18](#); [Acts 12:12](#)